Sivarasan saw them off in Jaffna. They arrived at a refugee shelter in Tuticorin (now Thoothukudi) in Tamil Nadu. The next batch consisted of Payas, his wife Prema and sister Premlatha. Jayakumar with his wife Shanthi arrived a week later. They, too, came as Sri Lankan refugees and took asylum in a refugee camp in Rameswaram. The third batch, consisting of Ravichandran and Suseendran (part of the twenty-six-person assassination team) came on 17 December 1990. Murugan reached India in January 1991, and Radhayya (alias Chandralekha and Athirai) arrived in April 1991. The final arrival was of the most dedicated, hardcore members of the LTTE's hit squad, which included the human bomb Dhanu and Subha, on 1 May 1991. Sivarasan had arranged three hideouts in Madras. He placed Payas and gang in a house in Porur; Vijayan and family in Kodungaiyur; and Jayakumar in Muthamil Nagar adjoining Kodungaiyur. All three houses were equipped with ultra-high-frequency (UHF) wireless communication sets.[14]

Some of these names were still a mystery to the SIT. The road ahead to catch Sivarasan was getting longer and longer. On the very first day of office, Kaarthikeyan and many of his colleagues had sounded pessimistic about his being able to the case. They had thought the task the SIT had in front of them was impossible to accomplish. That very day, Kaarthikeyan had put up a handwritten note on the wall behind his desk, which read, 'Nothing is impossible. What is considered impossible takes more time, more effort and enormous risk.'[15] Every time a member of the team felt demotivated, Kaarthikeyan would draw their attention to that handwritten message. Losing was not an option for the SIT. Their mission was to catch the killers and put them behind bars—and nothing would stop them from doing that.